

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Elderly people often tell great stories!



Learning Outcome

Describe detailed facts about events or actions in work and social contexts, in written or spoken situations.

Ask your partner:

- How often do the older people in your family talk about the past?
- What things do they talk about?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about history and civilization.
- I can talk about when or why something is done or contrast two related events or actions.
- I can report facts about events or actions.





Let's Explore!

That table was shipped back from China **decades***ago.

* "Decades" means tens of years.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

George wanted to talk about his travels. He has always been a person who loves to talk about himself. I was motioned to a chair and I was given a wonderful cup of scented tea. Pictures from the exotic places he had visited were placed in a neat stack on the inlaid wood coffee table that was shipped back from China decades ago.

Pictures of the famous people he has met were arranged artistically on the pale celery green wall behind him. Anyone who was allowed to listen to recollections gladly sat in silence. They knew they were being given a glimpse into a world few people of his age were privileged to have seen.

Being very advanced in age, George often nodded off. Having nothing more pressing to do, I would quietly slip into the kitchen to make another pot of tea or add a few biscuits to the plate. After waking from his nap, he would continue on for a while before slipping off once again.

Despite having a great deal of money and life experience, he had few friends. Most had passed on. Now, even though having a busy life traveling to the four corners of the earth was what he enjoyed for many years, having a quiet life now suited him just as well. After sitting and listening for the afternoon, I would always make George his favorite meal. His not having a housekeeper in on Wednesdays, made me choose it as our special day. Although my being so much younger and still wanting to give up a day off every week may have seemed abnormal to some, I always looked forward to those illuminating afternoon soliloquies.





Let's Practice!

George has many memories to share.

Instructions: Use the Words from the Word bank to correctly complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

Illuminating / inlaid / recollections / four / stack

1. Pictures from exotic places were placed in a neat _____.
2. George liked to show the _____ wood coffee table he bought in China.
3. He looked back fondly on the years he spent traveling to the _____ corners of the earth.
4. His friends loved him for his _____ soliloquies.
5. Anyone who was allowed to listen to his _____ sat in silence.



Let's Practice!

Visitors were shown the wonders of George's travels.

Instructions: Unscramble the words to complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. I was given a _____ (downrelfu) cup of _____ (decesnt) tea.
2. _____ (terscPui) were placed in a neat _____ (tckas).
3. An inlaid wood _____ (foeecf) table was shipped _____ (cbka) from China decades ago.
4. Pictures of famous _____ (lepeop) were arranged on a _____ (lalw) behind him.
5. Anyone who was _____ (olwdlea) to listen to his recollections _____ (gllyad) sat in silence.





Extension Activity

Retell a story from the past.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Ask someone older you know to tell you a story from their past or if you don't know anyone older, make one up.
- Take notes and put the story on a timeline.
- Add extra notes saying when or why something was done.
- Practice retelling the story aloud from your notes.
- Retell the story with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I listen to a story told by an older person.

☐ ☐

I put my notes on a timeline.

☐ ☐

I add reduced adverb phrases.

☐ ☐

I practice retelling the story aloud.

☐ ☐

I share my story with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to motion** (verb): to signal by using a movement or gesture
e.g. I was motioned to a chair and I was given a wonderful cup of scented tea.
- stack** (noun): a number of items piled on top of each other
e.g. Pictures from the exotic places he had visited were placed in a neat stack.
- inlaid** (adjective): set into the surface of something with a decorative piece
e.g. The inlaid wood coffee table that was shipped back from China decades ago.
- recollection** (noun): memory
e.g. Anyone who was allowed to listen to recollections gladly sat in silence.
- privileged** (adjective): having special advantages
e.g. They knew they were being given a glimpse into a world few people of his age were privileged to have seen.
- to nod off** (verb): to fall asleep
e.g. Being very advanced in age, George often nodded off.
- to slip off** (verb): to fall asleep unintentionally
e.g. After waking from his nap, he would continue on for a while before slipping off once again.
- to the four corners of the earth** (expression): all parts of the world
e.g. Having a busy life traveling to the four corners of the earth was what he enjoyed for many years.
- illuminating** (adjective): interesting and informative
e.g. I always looked forward to those illuminating afternoon soliloquies.
- soliloquy** (noun): the act of saying one's thoughts out loud
e.g. I always looked forward to those illuminating afternoon soliloquies.



Learning Points

Adverbial Clauses: Reduced Forms

When you want to express your ideas more concisely way, you can shorten an adverbial clause and make it an adverbial phrase.

A clause is a group of words with a subject and a verb.

A phrase is a group of words which may include nouns and verbs, but does not have a subject.

Before you change an adverb clause into an adverbial phrase, be sure that the adverbial clause (subordinate clause) and the main clause have the same subject.

For example:

As I had eaten a great meal and rested for a bit, I felt more energized.

Both clauses have the same subject (I) so you can omit the subject and reduce the adverb clause into a shorter phrase:

Having eaten a great meal and rested for a bit, I felt marvelous.

In general, the adverbial clauses of time, cause and contrast can be reduced to adverbial phrases.

Examples:

- *Being very advanced in age, George often nodded off.*
- *Having nothing more pressing to do, I would quietly slip into the kitchen.*
- *His not having a housekeeper in on Wednesdays, made me choose it as our special day.*
- *After waking from his nap, he would continue on for a while before slipping off once again.*
- *After sitting and listening for the afternoon, I would always make George his favorite meal.*
- *Despite having a great deal of money and life experience, he had few friends.*
- *Now, even though having a busy life traveling to the far corners of the earth was what he enjoyed for many years, having a quiet life now suited him just as well.*
- *Although my being so much younger and still wanting to give up a day off every week may have seemed abnormal to some, I always looked forward to those illuminating afternoon soliloquies.*





Learning Points

The Simple Past Passive to Report Events

You use the Simple Past to talk about finished events at a particular time in the past.

You often choose the passive form when you want to talk about an action but are not so interested in saying who or what does/did it. Passives without agents (the doers) are common in academic and scientific writing as well as reports.

The structure of the Simple Past passive is:

subject + **was/were** + **past participle**

For example:

I was motioned to a chair and I was given a wonderful cup of scented tea.

Sometimes you use the preposition *by* to mention the person or thing that did the action.

For example:

They knew they were given a glimpse into a world few people have seen by someone who had experienced it.

Because this is the Simple Past tense, there is often a specific time or date mentioned in the sentence, or at least referred to in the context.

Examples:

- *Pictures from the exotic places he had visited were placed in a neat stack.*
- *They were on the inlaid wood coffee table that was shipped back from China decades ago.*
- *Pictures of the famous people he has met were arranged artistically on the pale celery green wall behind him.*
- *Anyone who was allowed to listen to recollections gladly sat in silence.*

